

NEW LUXURY EXPEDITION CRUISES

# Cruising the Enchanted Isles: Scotland, Ireland & England 2022

14 days from $15,995 per person *was $17,995*

Limited to 148 guests

OFFER

Save $2,000 per person on all stateroom categories and suites.

Voyage beyond mainland Scotland, Ireland and England for a completely unique experience exploring ravishing coastlines, natural landscapes and historic treasures. Joined by A&K's famed Expedition Team, discover the velvet-green Orkney archipelago, wild Hebrides, UNESCO-designated St. Kilda and ravishing cliffs of Donegal and Moher. Guests also enjoy luxury pre- and post-cruise stays with one night in Edinburgh and two nights in London.

## Included With This Luxury Expedition Cruise

- An Exclusively Chartered, All-Inclusive Voyage Led by A&K's Expedition Team and Local Guides
- Pre- and/or Post-Cruise Stays at Stylish, Ideally Located Hotels and A&K-Led Excursions
- Airport Meet and Greet and Transfers
- Private Balcony with Every Onboard Accommodation and Butler Service with Every Suite
- Maximum Personnel-to-Guest Ratio of 1 to 1.3
- Culinary Program Featuring French-Inspired Cuisine, Including House Drinks, Afternoon Tea and Pastries
- 24-Hour Room Service and Breakfast in Bed
- Choice of Curated, All-Inclusive Shore Excursions
- Enrichment programming, lectures and presentations
- Traveller's Valet® Laundry Service
- All Gratuities, Port Charges and Taxes
- Complimentary Wi-Fi on Board and in Hotels
- Onboard Service from an English-Speaking Staff, Including an Accredited Physician
- 24/7 A&K On-Call Support

## A&K Advantages

Cruise for 10 nights on luxury, all-balcony 'Le Champlain,' with a capacity limited to just 148 guests
Explore alongside A&K's captivating Expedition Team for an unforgettable enrichment program
Experience a choice of included, immersive, A&K-only excursions in every port, spanning everything from visits to legendary historic sites and jaw-dropping coastal landscapes to hyper-local culinary and cultural experiences
Explore dramatic and wild coastal landscapes from Scotland to Ireland, including stunning seabird habitats in the Inner and Outer Hebrides and Galway's spectacular Connemara
Experience the fantastic history of the British Isles, visiting Urquhart Castle in the Scottish Highlands, the thrilling Ring of Brogdar in the Orkney Islands, UNESCO-designated St. Kilda Islands and dizzying Skellig Michael, and Sligo in Ireland, hometown of poet William Butler Yeats
Savor culinary excursions, opting for experiences that include guided whisky tasting at the legendary Glenmorangie distillery in the Scottish Highlands and lunch with a former executive chef to the Royal family in London
Before and after your cruise, experience a night in Edinburgh with a dinner celebrating the Royal Military Tattoo and two days in London, each complete with luxury hotel stays and guided A&K-excursions

# Featured Experts



### DR. MARK BRAZIL

Ornithology Lecturer

Born and educated in England and Scotland, Mark is a professor of biodiversity and conservation. Author of several books, his career spans ornithological research, consulting for TV and radio, and naturalist guiding.



### LORD CHARTRES

History & Cultural Lecturer

Lord Chartres is a distinguished scholar with an interest in history and the environment. He is a life peer in the House of Lords and has served as Bishop of London and Dean of Her Majesty's Chapels Royal.

# Itinerary




### AUG 26 EDINBURGH, SCOTLAND

Arrive in Edinburgh and transfer to your luxury hotel. This evening, join fellow guests and your A&K Expedition Team for a welcome briefing and themed dinner at your hotel.

The Balmoral | Meals: Dinner

### AUG 27 EDINBURGH | EXCITING CAPITAL CITY

After breakfast and a morning at leisure, join a panoramic tour of Scotland's capital city, vibrant Edinburgh. Explore Edinburgh Castle with your expert local guide and take in inspiring city views. Later, board your sleek expedition vessel and set sail on the Firth of Forth. Join fellow guests on deck and, conditions permitting, view Bass Rock, home to the world's largest gannet colony, as well as the Isle of May, home to over 285 species of birds.

'Le Champlain' | Meals: Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

### AUG 28 INVERGORDON | MAJESTIC SCOTTISH HIGHLANDS

The northern part of Scotland is legendary for its dramatic, windswept mountains, wooded hills and historic significance. Today, explore the magnificent Highlands, choosing from experiences that include an expertly guided visit of the Scottish Highlands capital of Inverness, a private cruise on mythic Loch Ness and exploration of Urquhart Castle, a moving experience at the site of the epic Battle of Culloden, or a visit and whisky tasting at Glenmorangie Distillery.

'Le Champlain' | Meals: Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

### AUG 29 ORKNEY ISLANDS | KIRKWALL & THE RING OF BRODGAR

Rich in Viking heritage and UNESCO-designated sites, the landscapes of the Orkneys run the gamut from rolling hills dotted with wild flowers to dramatic cliffs inhabited by seabirds to frothy waves and sea caves. A choice of excursions reveals the archipelago's many stories, including exploration of historic Kirkwall or a visit to the 5,000-year-old Skara Brae, one of the best-preserved Stone Age settlements in Western Europe. You may also visit the spine-tingling Ring of Brodgar, a ceremonial circle of ancient standing stones dating to 2700 BC. Perched on a strip of land bordered by both salt and fresh water, see 27 of the original 60 stones set in a precise circle at six degrees apart. Before dinner this evening aboard your luxury expedition cruiser, enjoy a recap and fascinating lectures with A&K's Expedition Team.

'Le Champlain' | Meals: Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

### AUG 30 OUTER HEBRIDES | PREHISTORIC WESTERN ISLES

The Western Isles of Scotland offer outstanding scenery with wild and windswept beaches, towering peaks and peat moors. The main islands include the moorlands of Lewis and the mountains of Harris, each with its own Gaelic dialect. Choose a drive through the moorlands to the archaeological site of the ancient Calanais Standing Stones, Scotland's own "Stonehenge," and a visit to Arnol Blackhouse, a traditional thatched house where Gaelic-speaking locals reveal the island's crofting traditions. Alternatively, you may opt for a drive on the Golden Road with stops to visit a Harris tweed weaver, as well as a local gin and whisky distillery. Continue to a clifftop at the edge of the Outer Hebrides showcasing stunning views and wildlife.

'Le Champlain' | Meals: Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

### AUG 31 OUTER HEBRIDES | SEA STACKS OF ST. KILDA

For more than 2,000 years and until 1930, the St. Kilda islands were inhabited by an isolated community. Today, the preserved settlement reveals cleits, beehive-shaped cells of rough stone that served as larders and storerooms. Explore this UNESCO World Heritage Site, designated for both its natural and cultural significance. Admire the staggering cliffs and sea stacks that define the islands. Visit Hirta, the largest island with the highest cliffs in all of Britain. Among the most important seabird breeding colonies in Northwest Europe, the cliffs provide refuge for more than 200 species, including fulmars and shags.

'Le Champlain' | Meals: Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

### SEP 1 INNER HEBRIDES | GREEN JEWELS OF STAFFA & IONA

The approach to Staffa by sea is breathtaking, with great basalt columns flanking the deep caves of the island. Keep an eye out for dolphins, basking sharks and minke whales, which can been seen during the warmer months. Excursions ashore lead you to the wonders of Fingal, a sea cave formed by hexagonally jointed basalt. Continue cruising to the tranquil island of Iona, where you discover Iona Abbey, an ancient center of Gaelic monasticism.

'Le Champlain' | Meals: Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

### SEP 2 DONEGAL, IRELAND | UNSPOILED COAST

Though a small island nation, Ireland is packed with stunning landscapes, welcoming locals, and a wealth of history and culture. Your introduction to the island begins near Donegal at Killybegs, with its broken coastline of deep-sea inlets and sandy beaches, spectacular mountains and blanket bog. Today, join a guided walking tour of Donegal or a drive to the countryside to witness the iconic Slieve League Mountains and an impressive waterfall. Fans of legendary writer William Butler Yeats and his brother Jack Yeats, an accomplished painter, may choose to visit their hometown of Sligo. In "Yeats Country," experience the landscapes and beaches that inspired their artistry, a memorable poetry reading at the Yeats Society and the gravesite of the poet himself. For another option, cross into Northern Ireland and spend the day in the walled city of Londonderry, site of 1972's "Bloody Sunday."

'Le Champlain' | Meals: Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

### SEP 3 GALWAY | TRADITIONAL CITY & CLIFFS OF MOHER

Today, arrive in the lively city of Galway with its narrow streets, colorful houses and thriving arts community. Choose from excursions that take you on an artisan

culinary walking tour with a tutored tasting of Irish whiskeys or to the Burren — the largest karst landscape in Europe — for a botanist-guided experience and local sheep farm visit. You may also opt for a day in Ireland's breathtaking Connemara region with its jagged, filigreed shoreline. Later today (conditions permitting), embark on a Zodiac excursion along the ravishing, picture-perfect Cliffs of Moher.

'Le Champlain' | Meals: Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

### SEP 4 SKELLIG MICHAEL | FANTASTIC PEAKS OF THE ATLANTIC

Early this morning, you may have the opportunity to cruise by breathtaking Skellig Michael, a UNESCO-designated site whose extreme remoteness has preserved it almost unchanged. Its sandstone pyramids were home to some of the earliest monastic settlements in Ireland; today, they provide sanctuary to fantastic birdlife. The dizzying Skellig Michael (also known as Great Skellig) also doubled as Luke Skywalker's Jedi Temple in the *Star Wars* saga. Later today, arrive at historic Bantry and set off on a leisurely walk and guided visits to its historic churches or to stately Bantry House's magnificent gardens.

'Le Champlain' | Meals: Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

### SEP 5 AT SEA | ACROSS THE CELTIC SEA

Relish a day at sea, taking in the views from the outer decks or from your own private balcony. Enjoy relaxed time with new friends and your Expedition Team, including additional lectures and conversations to enrich your discoveries.

'Le Champlain' | Meals: Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

### SEP 6–7 LONDON | CITY OF STRIKING LANDMARKS

Bid farewell to your Captain and crew as you approach the White Cliffs of Dover and disembark for the next chapter of your adventure. Before heading to London, choose from various options, such as a visit to Hever Castle, Anne Boleyn's childhood home, or Leeds Castle, the property of six English queens during the 13th to 15th centuries. You may also opt for a stop at Chartwell, former home of Winston Churchill. Following lunch, transfer to the heart of London and check into your luxury hotel, where you have dinner tonight. The next day, embark on a full day of exploration in this bustling city. Your choice of excursions includes a panoramic tour showcasing eye-popping landmarks such as the Tower of London, a visit to Westminster Abbey and a London Eye experience. Alternately, join a culinary experience spanning Portobello Road Market in Notting Hill, sampling delicacies and enjoying lunch with a former executive chef to the Royal Family; or a journey back in time with a visit to the Churchill War Rooms and the Imperial War Museums.

Four Seasons Hotel London at Ten Trinity Square | Meals: Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner (Sep 6); Breakfast, Lunch (Sep 7)

### SEP 8 DEPART LONDON

After breakfast, transfer to the airport for your flight home or continue on a group extension to the Cotswolds.

Meals: Breakfast

***Note: Itinerary is for guidance purposes only and may be adjusted due to unforeseen circumstances including weather, medical emergencies and other conditions beyond A&K's control at the sole discretion of the Captain.***

# Extensions



## Edinburgh & the Royal Military Tattoo Pre-Tour Extension

Discover Edinburgh during Scotland's most iconic festival, experiencing the city and castle grounds, historic Scottish Borders and celebrated Royal Military Tattoo performances.

4 days from $3,795 per person
Single Supplement from $1,195 per person

Aug 23

Arrive in Edinburgh and transfer to your luxury city hotel, The Balmoral. Meet your guide for a welcome cocktail reception before heading to dinner on your own.

The Balmoral

Aug 24

Set off on a guided tour of this vibrant city, exploring Edinburgh Castle, the Scottish Parliament and the Royal Mile, where buskers (street performers) celebrate the annual Royal Edinburgh Military Tattoo festival. Enjoy lunch at a local venue and time to explore at leisure. Look forward to an exciting night of celebrations that begins with dinner with fellow guests. Afterward, head to the Esplanade for Premier Seating at a special Royal Military Tattoo performance.

The Balmoral | Meals: Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Aug 25

Today, venture off the beaten path for a Scottish Borders experience. Visit beautiful and mysterious Rosslyn Chapel, the inspiration for many writers and artists. Later, discover Traquair House — the oldest inhabited house in Scotland — where you enjoy a visit and lunch. Return to Edinburgh for time to enjoy the festival atmosphere at your leisure.

The Balmoral | Meals: Breakfast, Lunch

Aug 26

Embark on a Three Bridges cruise to experience Queensferry Crossing, Forth Road Bridge and Forth Bridge as well as a showing of local marine life and seabirds. Enjoy an afternoon at leisure before joining your main program this evening.

Meals: Breakfast, Lunch



## England's Cotswolds Post-Tour Extension

Explore the rolling landscapes of the Cotswolds, visiting Oxford, Shakespeare's birthplace at Stratford-upon-Avon, picturesque Arlington Row and Kiftsgate Court Gardens.

4 days from $3,395 per person
Single Supplement from $1,095 per person

Sep 8

Transfer to Oxford. Enjoy lunch on arrival and then a visit to Christ Church College with its magnificent Great Hall — also the inspiration for Hogwarts Castle's Great Hall in the Harry Potter films — as well as the Bodleian Libraries and Divinity School. Your evening is at leisure.

The Randolph Hotel by Graduate Hotels | Meals: Lunch

Sep 9

Set off on a guided adventure of the historic Cotswolds, beginning with visits to Anne Hathaway's Cottage and Stratford-upon-Avon, the birthplace of Shakespeare. After lunch, explore Blenheim Palace, birthplace of Sir Winston Churchill, and time permitting, pause to see his grave at St Martin's Church. Return to your hotel for an evening at leisure in Oxford.

The Randolph Hotel by Graduate Hotels | Meals: Breakfast, Lunch

Sep 10

Enjoy another full day in the Cotswolds, beginning in Bibury to see picturesque Arlington Row with its ancient row of weavers' cottages. Take a stroll in Upper and Lower Slaughter, and in the old wool town of Chipping Campden, see arguably the loveliest high street in England. Proceed to Kiftsgate Court Gardens for a special lunch; later, explore Great Tew and enjoy refreshments. Return to Oxford with time to experience the city at your leisure.

The Randolph Hotel by Graduate Hotels | Meals: Breakfast, Lunch

Sep 11

After breakfast, transfer to London airport for your return flight home.

Meals: Breakfast

# Dates & Prices

Prices are in USD, per person, based on double occupancy.

| Dates | Prices | Single Supplement | Availability |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Aug 26 - Sep 08, 2022** | | | |
| Category 1 Classic Stateroom | $15,995 (was $17,995) | $13,495 | Waitlist - Call A&K |
| Category 2 Deluxe Stateroom | $17,995 (was $19,995) | $14,995 | Waitlist - Call A&K |
| Category 3 Prestige Stateroom | $18,995 (was $20,995) | $15,745 | Waitlist - Call A&K |
| Category 4 Deluxe Suite | $28,495 (was $30,495) | $27,045 | Waitlist - Call A&K |
| Category 5 Privilege Suite | $30,995 (was $32,995) | $29,445 | Waitlist - Call A&K |
| Category 6 Prestige Two-Room Suite | $35,995 (was $37,995) | $34,095 | Waitlist - Call A&K |
| Category 7 Grand Deluxe Suite | $41,995 (was $43,995) | $39,895 | Waitlist - Call A&K |
| Category 8 Owner's Suite | $44,995 (was $46,995) | $42,745 | Waitlist - Call A&K |

*Optional pre-tour and post-tour extensions available on this departure.*

## Journey Details

**Proof of full vaccination for COVID-19 is required for this journey, including a booster shot if vaccination was received more than four months prior to departure (two months for the Johnson & Johnson vaccine).**

This journey contains some active elements, including walks over uneven terrain and optional, challenging hikes.

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Minimum age is 7 years.

Categories 4-8 include room upgrade at the hotel and butler service aboard the ship.

First group event: welcome briefing on Aug 26.

Last group event: excursions on Sep 7.

## Special Offer Terms & Conditions

*Offer subject to availability and may be withdrawn at any time.*

Prices are per person based on double occupancy. Internal and international air not included. See complete terms and conditions here.